

8 A world divided: Superpower relations, 1945-62

- Reasons for the Cold War
- Early developments in the Cold War, 1945-49
- The Cold War in the 1950s
- The Berlin Crisis of 1961
- The Cuban Missiles Crisis

- Long-term rivalry between the Soviet Union and the West. Differences during the Second World War. Key features of the conferences at Yalta and Potsdam. The Soviet Union and Eastern Europe. The attitude of Truman.
- Soviet expansion in Eastern Europe. Churchill and the 'iron curtain'. The Truman Doctrine and the Marshall Plan. Cominform and Comecon. Differences over Germany. Bizonia. Causes, events and results of the Berlin Crisis 1948-9. Setting up of NATO.
- Korean War, Khrushchev and peaceful co-existence and the Warsaw Pact. The impact of Soviet rule on Hungary, Rakosi, de-Stalinisation, Nagy and his demands. Reasons for Soviet invasion and its effects.
- The U2 incident 1960 and its effects on the Paris Summit Conference. Reasons for the construction of the Berlin Wall 1961 and its effects on relations between East and West and on Germany.
- Castro and relations with USA and Soviet Union. Bay of Pigs. Kennedy and missile sites. Key events of the Cuban Missiles Crisis. Impact on East-West relations.